

QA Automation Team Working Agreement

- **Team Values:**
- **Team Policies:**
 - [Cadence Policies](#)
 - [Expedite Policy](#)
 - [Max Size Policy](#)
 - [Out of Office Policy?](#)
 - [Definition of Done \(DoD\)](#) (not applicable for Epics):
 - [Definition of Ready \(DoR\)](#):
- **Meetings and Ceremonies** (TBD for this point forward):
 - [Daily Stand-up](#)
 - [Refinement Meetings:](#)
 - [Share-out Meeting](#)
 - [Other meetings](#) (Meetings other than Agile events):

Team Values:

Team Culture:

Team Values:

Examples:

Team Policies:

Cadence Policies

- Have a share out once every 2 weeks (30 min)
 - Expectations get shared, this leads to backlog prioritization
- Have refinement session once every 2 weeks (60 min)
- Have retrospective session once a month (30 mins)
- Have Stand up meetings daily (30 mins)

Expedite Policy

- Workitem has to be in "Critical" priority
- Expedited items types will only apply to Bugs and Defects
- If SLA of workitem is 24hours or less.
- WIP limit: 1

Max Size Policy

- Stories should not be larger than 13 points, if pointed 13 or above, team needs to refine story to be broken down.

Out of Office Policy?

- Place month prior
- No layered leaves
- Extended leaves (>1 week) require at least 1 month of time ahead approval/notice.
 - Approved by reporting manager
- OOO message must include duration of leave and who to contact during absence.
- Planned leave sequence of events (*only for Persistent team members*)
 1. Request for approval in Fusion (Persistent)
 2. Place on Excel tracking sheet (Persistent)
 3. Place a meeting invite on Teams, send to <AutomationSquad@ascensus.com> as optional. (Ascensus)
 4. Place on Team Confluence calendar (Ascensus). Find here: [Automation Squad - Government Savings- Software Development. - Ascensus - Confluence](#)

*Items 1 and 2 are sequential, 3 and 4 can be done simultaneously after 2 is done.

Definition of Done (DoD) (not applicable for Epics):

In progress (QA) WIP=TBD

- All sub-tasks under a story have been created
- **For test case runs, new test creations use of label "Regression" is mandatory.**
 - **Items in Jira should be 1:1 ratio with qTest report.**
- Test case has to be finalized (manual and/or automated)
- Code is peer-reviewed (for automation)
- All acceptance criteria is met
- Best coding practices were met

In Review/Validation (QA) WIP=TBD

- Code is approved by SMEs and merged into main (for automation)
- Test data is created and checked in
- Test cases are updated into the existing automation suite
- No unexpected failures (e.g. test case missing)

Done

- Manual test cases are written.
- All child issues are closed
- Code is in stage1

Definition of Ready (DoR):

To Do column:

- Stories start is in the Backlog and has been refined by the Project Lead with support from the team
- Stories have a clear description and acceptance criteria
- Dependencies and known obstacles have been identified during refinement
- No open questions remain; scope is well understood
- The team has explicitly agreed that the item is ready to be worked on
- Stories have to be pointed and confirm to sizing policy
- Story can be pulled into the next iteration without further clarification
- Once ready, the work item is moved to "To Do" and ordered by priority.
- Due date is agreed to and assigned
- Need an epic assigned to every story

Meetings and Ceremonies (TBD for this point forward):

Daily Stand-up

- Currently held at 8:00 AM (Eastern) daily via Teams.
- Meeting is scheduled for 30mins
 - First 15mins should be the devs working for a plan for the day ahead.
 - Second half are for small topics or make a plan to meet on bigger topics.
- Dev Team will rotate daily facilitation (alphabetically).
- Are we tracking to complete our iteration goal.
- Action to take when upcoming PTO/OOO.

Behaviors for Stand-up Ceremony

- Keep camera on while speaking.
- Focus on Task Age. Is something not moving? (Yellow and Red items).

Refinement Meetings:

- Cadence: Every 2 weeks.
- Duration: 60 min
- BA can send an agenda before meeting --> **Flexible, as backlog requires.**
- Stories should be broken down into similar efforts
 - Vertically splitting stories is optimal.
 - When stories cannot be split and are of a larger effort, team should agree to move forward with swarming.
- Backlog Owner should come prepared on a list of stories that **ideally** have:
 - Clear description
 - Acceptance criteria
 - Testing criteria
- Developer and QA are the target audience
- Purpose of meeting is to have agreeance on the story quality, gage effort, dependencies.

Share-out Meeting

- Should be held every month via Teams.
- Duration TBD
- Audience?
 - Who and why?
- Demo when possible

- Discuss business value
- Roadmap review
- Backlog Owner will prepare Confluence Page and team will review and make any adjustments (Discuss demo earlier)

Other meetings (Meetings other than Agile events):

- Team to review meetings on calendars to identify if they are giving or receiving Value.
- Is there an agenda?
- Are you optional or required?
- Is meeting recorded to listen to later?
- Does the whole team need to attend?
- Please use your time wisely.